

Northstar Analytics - Sample IT & Security Policy

A fictional, text-based companion document created for learning multi-document Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), cross-document retrieval, metadata filtering, source attribution, and document management.

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Important: Northstar Analytics is fictional. All policies, names, numbers, and procedures in this document are synthetic and are not legal, security, HR, financial, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This policy defines minimum requirements for protecting Northstar Analytics systems, devices, accounts, and company information. It applies to employees, contractors, and approved third parties who access company technology.

1.2 Relationship to Other Policies

This document complements the Employee Handbook. If a topic is covered by both documents, employees should follow the more specific operational or security requirement for the activity involved.

2. Account and Access Security

2.1 Unique Accounts

Each user must use an individually assigned account. Shared user accounts are prohibited unless explicitly approved for a technical service.

2.2 Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-factor authentication is required for corporate email, source code repositories, cloud platforms, VPN access, and administrative systems.

2.3 Access Reviews

Managers and system owners must review privileged access at least once every quarter. Access that is no longer required must be removed promptly.

3. Password and Authentication Requirements

3.1 Password Standard

Passwords must contain at least 14 characters. Employees should use a password manager and must not reuse their corporate password on personal services.

3.2 Credential Sharing

Passwords, API keys, access tokens, and recovery codes must not be shared through email, chat, documents, or source code repositories.

4. Company Devices

4.1 Managed Devices

Company laptops must use approved endpoint protection, disk encryption, automatic screen locking, and company-managed security updates.

4.2 Software Installation

Employees may install approved business software. Software from untrusted sources, pirated software, and tools designed to bypass security controls are prohibited.

4.3 Lost or Stolen Devices

A lost or stolen company device must be reported to the IT service desk and Security team immediately. Employees should not delay reporting while attempting to recover the device themselves.

5. Data Handling and Classification

5.1 Data Categories

Company information is categorized as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted. Customer credentials, authentication secrets, and regulated personal data are treated as Restricted.

5.2 Approved Storage

Confidential and Restricted information must be stored only in approved company systems. Sensitive files must not be copied to personal cloud storage, personal email, or unmanaged USB devices.

5.3 Minimum Necessary Access

Employees should access only the minimum amount of sensitive information necessary to perform their work.

6. Remote Work and Network Security

6.1 Public Networks

Employees working from public Wi-Fi should use the company VPN when accessing internal systems. Sensitive work should be avoided on networks that appear suspicious or improperly secured.

6.2 Home Networks

Employees working remotely should protect home routers with a strong administrator password and current firmware where practical.

7. Security Incidents

7.1 What to Report

Suspected phishing, malware, accidental data disclosure, unauthorized access, lost devices, and exposed credentials are security incidents and must be reported.

7.2 Reporting Deadline

Security incidents should be reported immediately through the security incident channel or IT service desk. Employees should preserve relevant evidence and should not independently investigate a suspected attacker.

7.3 Phishing

Employees who receive a suspected phishing message should use the approved reporting mechanism and should not forward the suspicious message to colleagues.

8. Software Development and Secrets

8.1 Source Code

Company source code must be stored in approved repositories with access controls appropriate to the project.

8.2 Secrets Management

API keys, passwords, private keys, and production credentials must not be committed to source code. Approved secret-management mechanisms must be used for application credentials.

8.3 Dependency Security

Engineering teams should keep critical dependencies supported and should address high-severity security vulnerabilities according to the remediation process.

9. AI and External Services

9.1 Sensitive Data

Confidential, Restricted, customer, or credential data must not be submitted to unapproved public AI tools or external services.

9.2 Approved AI Use

Approved AI tools may be used for permitted business tasks when employees follow data-handling requirements and review generated output before relying on it.

10. Offboarding and Equipment Return

10.1 Access Removal

When employment or a contract ends, access to corporate systems must be removed according to the offboarding process. Managers and People Operations coordinate the effective termination date with IT.

10.2 Company Equipment

Company laptops, access cards, security keys, and other issued equipment must be returned no later than the final working day unless another arrangement is approved.

Quick Reference

Topic	Requirement
MFA	Required for email, repositories, cloud, VPN, and admin systems
Password length	At least 14 characters
Privileged access review	At least quarterly
Lost device	Report immediately
Sensitive storage	Approved company systems only
Public Wi-Fi	Use company VPN for internal systems
Secrets in source code	Prohibited
Unapproved public AI tools	Do not submit sensitive company/customer data
Equipment return	No later than final working day unless approved otherwise

End of Sample IT & Security Policy. This fictional companion document intentionally overlaps with selected Employee Handbook topics such as security incidents, sensitive information, and equipment return so that multi-document retrieval can be tested.